

# Week 6 Study Guide

Inspection (Observation) — Vitality, Color, Appearance, Five Sense Organs, Hair, Skin, Nails, Secretions, Pediatric Diagnosis

Lecture 6 · Lixing Lao, Ph.D., L.Ac., MB

**How to use this guide:** Read once for the framework (Zang-Xiang, Five Wheels, Five Colors), then drill the tables. Every enumerable finding-to-pattern mapping is in a table — memorize rows, not paragraphs. Pair with the Cram Sheet the night before class.

**Scope Conflict — Read This:** Prof. Lao said in the recorded guest lecture that Body Constitution typing would **NOT** be on the quiz. But Prof. Schrier's own slide deck for this week (*Diagnosis by Observation*) devotes roughly a fifth of its slides to Constitutional Types (Five-Element body types, weak/strong constitution). Since slide content normally = quiz content almost verbatim, and Schrier is the instructor of record, this guide includes the constitution material (Section 14) rather than omitting it — but you should confirm with him directly which lecture governs the quiz.

Print Edition

## 1 • Framework: Zang-Xiang & the Four Diagnostic Methods

Inspection works because internal organ states manifest on the body surface (Zang-Xiang theory). Three classical citations anchor this idea — know the concept, not the exact wording.

| Source                        | Core Idea                                                                                                           |
|-------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Huangdi Neijing (475–221 BCE) | Internal viscera must manifest themselves externally.                                                               |
| Zhu Danxi (1281–1358)         | Observe external manifestations to know what is happening inside; internal organ disease shows on the body surface. |
| Zhang Jiebin (1562–1639)      | Zang-fu organs sit interiorly but manifest exteriorly — hence the name <i>Zang Xiang</i> ("viscera-image").         |

Quick Recall: *Zang Xiang* = what's inside shows on the outside.

| Method                   | What It Uses                                              | Key Point                                   |
|--------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------|
| Inspection (Observation) | Eyes — vitality, color, appearance, secretions/excretions | Includes tongue diagnosis as a sub-category |
| Auscultation & Olfaction | Ears (listening) + nose (smelling)                        | Sound and odor of the patient               |
| Inquiry                  | Verbal questioning                                        | History and subjective symptoms             |
| Palpation                | Touch, incl. pulse diagnosis                              | Physical exam                               |

**Heads Up —** The four methods are never used in isolation — over-relying on one and neglecting the other three is explicitly called out in the slides as a diagnostic pitfall.

## 2 • Observation of Vitality (Shen)

Shen is the outward sign of the relative strength of Qi and Blood of the zang-fu organs.

| Presentation                                  | Meaning                                                  |
|-----------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------|
| Eyes clear, sparkling; vigorous mental status | Healthy Shen present                                     |
| Eyes dull, cloudy; lethargic mental status    | Shen disturbed; essence of the five zang organs weakened |

Quick Recall: *Clear + bright eyes* = Shen present. *Dull + cloudy* = Shen disturbed.

## 3 • Observation of Color — The Five Colors of the Face

Color and luster of the face (or any skin area). General rule: a lustrous, moist complexion = mild disease, good prognosis. A dark, haggard complexion = severe disease, poor prognosis.

| Color             | General Indication                                  | Key Variants                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
|-------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Red               | Heat (excess or deficient type)                     | Entire face red = excess-type yang heat (exogenous fever, or zang-fu yang hyperactivity). Malar (cheek) flush only = yin-deficiency heat, often w/ tidal fever & night sweats                                            |
| Pale (White)      | Cold, blood deficiency, yin excess, yang deficiency | Bright white + puffy/bloated = yang qi deficiency. Withered pale = blood deficiency                                                                                                                                      |
| Yellow            | Deficiency, damp syndromes                          | Whole-body yellow (incl. eyes/skin) = jaundice. Bright orange = yang jaundice (damp-heat). Smoky dark = yin jaundice (cold-damp or chronic blood stagnation). Pale yellow, no brightness = qi & blood deficiency         |
| Blue (Green)      | Cold, pain, blood stagnation, convulsion            | Pale + blue tinge = excess yin/cold w/ severe epigastric/abdominal pain. Blue-purple face+lips w/ precordial pain = heart blood stagnation. Blue-purple w/ high fever + limb movement in children = infantile convulsion |
| Dark Grey (Black) | Kidney deficiency, blood stagnation                 | Pale-dark + lumbar soreness + cold feet = kidney yang insufficiency. Dark, no brightness, scaly skin = prolonged blood stagnation                                                                                        |

Quick Recall: *Red=heat, Pale=cold/blood-def, Yellow=damp/deficiency, Blue-green=cold/pain/stasis, Black=kidney/stasis.*

**Heads Up —** Homework/likely quiz format: build a comparison table of the five colors with TCM term + case example — this is exactly the assignment given in lecture. Expect a similar matching or fill-in format on the quiz.

Secretions & Excretions — General Color Rule

| Presentation                                                        | Meaning             |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------|
| Clear and white (nasal discharge, sputum, urine, vaginal discharge) | Deficiency and cold |
| Turbid and yellow                                                   | Excess and heat     |

4 • Observation of Appearance, Movement & Body Shape

Body Shape

| Presentation                           | Pattern                                     |
|----------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------|
| Overweight + mental depression         | Qi deficiency with excess phlegm–damp       |
| Thin person, dry skin                  | Blood insufficiency                         |
| Great weight loss over a long illness  | Exhaustion of essential Qi                  |
| Large, barrel chest / full epigastrium | Full (excess) condition of lung and stomach |
| Large, overweight thighs               | Spleen not transforming/transporting        |
| Thin body overall                      | Yin deficiency                              |
| Overweight body overall                | Yang deficiency with phlegm                 |

Movement & Posture

| Presentation                                                                                      | Pattern                                                         |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|
| Active movement                                                                                   | Yang syndrome                                                   |
| Passive manner                                                                                    | Yin syndrome                                                    |
| Violent movement of the four limbs                                                                | Wind disease (e.g. tetanus, acute/chronic infantile convulsion) |
| Muscle weakness, motor impairment, muscular atrophy                                               | Wei (癱) syndrome                                                |
| Pain, soreness, heaviness, numbness in tendons/bones/muscles + joint swelling/restricted movement | Bi (痹) syndrome (painful obstruction)                           |
| Numbness + impaired movement on one side of the body                                              | Hemiplegia / wind-stroke                                        |
| Quick movement + feeling of heat                                                                  | Excess Yang                                                     |
| Slow movement + feeling of cold                                                                   | Deficiency Yin                                                  |
| Small, restless fidgeting (e.g., leg bouncing)                                                    | Empty (deficiency) heat                                         |
| Tremors, convulsions                                                                              | Wind (involuntary movement)                                     |
| Paralysis                                                                                         | Internal wind                                                   |
| Stiffness / rigidity                                                                              | Qi stagnation, blood stasis, and/or internal wind               |

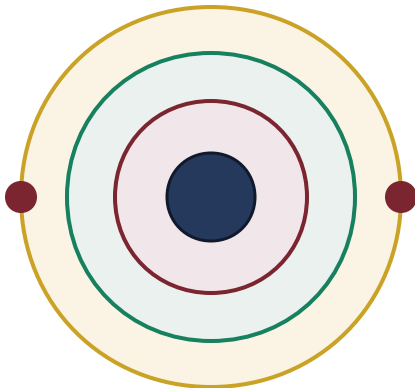
Quick Recall: Active/fast/hot = Yang excess. Passive/slow/cold = Yin deficiency. Involuntary = wind.

5 • Five Sense Organs I: The Eyes & the Five Wheels

The Liver opens into the eye, but the essential Qi of ALL five zang and six fu organs pours upward into the eyes (*Ling Shu* 80) — so the eye as a whole reflects Liver, but sub-regions reflect other organs via the Five Wheels.

Five Wheels of the Eye

(concentric rings, center = pupil)



Center to edge: Pupil → Iris → Sclera → Eyelids

- Water Wheel (pupil) → Kidney**
- Wind Wheel (iris) → Liver**
- Qi Wheel (sclera) → Lung**
- Flesh Wheel (eyelids)**  
→ Spleen / Stomach
- Blood Wheel (both canthus)**  
→ Heart

| Wheel       | Eye Structure                             | Organ                                           | Mnemonic                         |
|-------------|-------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------|
| Blood Wheel | Inner & outer canthus                     | Heart (canthus also relates to Small Intestine) | Blood → Heart                    |
| Qi Wheel    | Sclera (whites of the eye)                | Lung                                            | White = Metal = Lung             |
| Wind Wheel  | Iris (colored part)                       | Liver                                           | Wind = Liver's pathogenic factor |
| Water Wheel | Pupil                                     | Kidney                                          | Black = Water = Kidney           |
| Flesh Wheel | Eyelids (upper = Spleen, lower = Stomach) | Spleen/Stomach                                  | Flesh = Earth                    |

**Heads Up** — Right Chi pulse position pairs with Pericardium/San Jiao, NOT Kidney directly — don't cross-confuse pulse-position organ pairing with this eye-wheel organ pairing; they are separate systems.

Liver & the Eye — Functions

Liver harmonizes and distinguishes color; Liver stores Blood, which nourishes the eyes to allow sight; Liver governs tears, which moisten the eyes (basal/reflex tears for lubrication & protection — NOT emotional tears).

Eye Color

| Color                                          | Indication                                                                                 |
|------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Bright yellow (tangerine-peel)                 | Damp-heat, heat predominant                                                                |
| Dull, dusky yellow                             | Damp-heat, damp predominant                                                                |
| Dull, dark yellow                              | Cold-damp                                                                                  |
| Deep yellow + bloodshot                        | Toxic heat in the blood level (reckless blood movement)                                    |
| Dull, dark yellow-brown                        | Blood stasis (with dark rings under eyes, pain, purple tongue, wiry pulse)                 |
| Red (inner/outer canthus)                      | Heart fire (or Small Intestine, if outer canthus)                                          |
| Red, entire eye + headache, easily angered     | Rising Liver fire                                                                          |
| Red sclera, sore throat, cough, breathlessness | Exterior wind-heat affecting the Lung                                                      |
| Sudden red + itching + aversion to cold        | Exterior invasion of wind-heat                                                             |
| Blue-green                                     | Liver wind (involuntary movement, tremor, dizziness, numbness, paralysis)                  |
| Bluish                                         | Internal cold (cold limbs, cold abdominal pain, tight/slow pulse) or Kidney Yin deficiency |
| Dark sclera (crab-eye black)                   | Accumulated heat                                                                           |
| Dark eye sockets, sunken                       | Liver & Kidney Yin deficiency                                                              |
| White rings around iris                        | Turbid phlegm                                                                              |
| Cloudy white iris                              | Liver & Kidney Yin deficiency                                                              |
| Pale white vessels in canthus                  | Blood or Yang deficiency                                                                   |

Quick Recall: Yellow=damp, Red=heat/fire, Blue-green=wind/cold, Black/dark=extreme heat OR extreme cold, White=deficiency/phlegm.

Eye Shape & Movement

| Presentation                                                                              | Pattern                                                                               |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Bulging / protruding eyeballs + anger, red tongue, yellow greasy coat                     | Liver Yang rising with heat and damp                                                  |
| Protruding + neck swelling, dizziness, tinnitus, five-center heat, red tongue, scant coat | Liver Yin deficiency with relative Yang excess                                        |
| Sunken eyes + slight cough, weak voice                                                    | Lung deficiency                                                                       |
| Sunken eyes + poor appetite, distention, limb weakness                                    | Spleen deficiency (not transforming/transporting)                                     |
| Sunken, sudden onset, deep/scattered pulse                                                | Yin/Yang collapse (severe)                                                            |
| Swollen, sudden onset, no color change (edema)                                            | Fluid metabolism malfunction (Spleen deficiency w/ damp)                              |
| Bags under the eyes                                                                       | Spleen & Kidney deficiency                                                            |
| Strabismus / eye deviates, sudden onset, no redness/swelling                              | Wind attacking the channels                                                           |
| Deviation + nausea, vomiting, greasy coat, slippery pulse                                 | Wind-damp-phlegm obstruction                                                          |
| Both eyes deviate up/high fever/convulsion/coma                                           | Extreme heat generating wind                                                          |
| Deviation after trauma                                                                    | Blood stasis                                                                          |
| Congenital deviation (uni- or bilateral)                                                  | Essence deficiency (Kidney)                                                           |
| Frequent involuntary spasms, dry itchy eyes, pale face/lips, thready pulse                | Blood deficiency                                                                      |
| Eyelids heavy/tired feeling                                                               | Spleen Qi deficiency                                                                  |
| Occasional spasm + red/painful/itchy + fever/chills, floating pulse                       | Exterior invasion (wind-heat)                                                         |
| Droopy eyelids (ptosis)                                                                   | Qi sinking, or wind attacking the channels; after trauma = local stagnation/ weakness |

6 · Five Sense Organs II: The Nose

Two valid organ associations: five-phase correspondence = Lung opens to nose; facial maps (both the *Su Wen* center-of-face map AND the *Ling Shu* bridge-of-nose map) = Spleen. Default study approach: think Lung + Spleen first, then read the other signs.

| Finding                                | Pattern                                                                    |
|----------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Green/blue tip of nose                 | Cold                                                                       |
| Yellow tip, yellow sputum, yellow coat | Damp (and heat, if thirst/sweating/feeling hot also present)               |
| White / pale tip                       | Blood deficiency                                                           |
| Red tip                                | Heat                                                                       |
| Gray tip                               | Impaired water movement → edema/fluid accumulation                         |
| Greenish bridge of nose                | Liver Qi stagnation                                                        |
| Grayish-dark / dark purple bridge      | Blood stasis (stabbing, boring pain)                                       |
| Red bridge                             | Liver fire (irritability, outbursts of anger, red/bloodshot eyes, dryness) |
| Clear watery discharge                 | Cold pattern (exterior wind-cold)                                          |
| Thick yellow discharge                 | Heat pattern                                                               |
| Dry and black                          | Toxic heat                                                                 |
| Flaring of the nostrils                | Extreme heat                                                               |
| Epistaxis (nosebleed)                  | Excess heat attacking lung/stomach, pushing blood out of the vessels       |
| Swollen nose                           | Excess condition                                                           |
| Sunken nose                            | Deficiency condition                                                       |
| Nasal polyps                           | Stagnated heat in the Yangming channel                                     |

Quick Recall: Normal nose = slightly moist and shiny. Too dry = heat. Too wet/oily = damp.

Edema Location — The Three Yin Organs

| Edema starts in... | Organ Implicated                    |
|--------------------|-------------------------------------|
| Upper body / head  | Lung (governs water pathways)       |
| Lower body / feet  | Kidney (source of body fluids)      |
| Four limbs / torso | Spleen (transforms/transport water) |

**Heads Up** — San Jiao is also involved in fluid metabolism, but the three *yin organs* tested for edema location are Lung, Spleen, Kidney — know the origin-site logic, not just the organ name.

7 • Five Sense Organs III: The Ears

The Kidney opens to the ear (basis of auricular acupuncture as a body microsystem).

| Finding                                                    | Pattern                                                         |
|------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|
| Dry, withered auricle, burnt black, chronic/severe illness | Kidney essence consumed, cannot nourish upward                  |
| Purulent ear discharge ("Tin Er")                          | Damp-heat of Liver & Gallbladder                                |
| Swelling/pain in middle ear                                | Heat in the Shaoyang                                            |
| Thin ear                                                   | Qi or Blood deficiency                                          |
| Long, full earlobes                                        | Strong constitution / good Kidney essence                       |
| Small earlobes                                             | Poor constitution                                               |
| White, pale ears                                           | Cold                                                            |
| Darkish / bluish ears                                      | Pain caused by cold                                             |
| Dry, withered earlobes                                     | Kidney Qi exhaustion (usually Kidney Yin)                       |
| Shiny, moist earlobes                                      | Good prognosis (Kidney Yin intact)                              |
| Dry, withered earlobes                                     | Poor prognosis                                                  |
| Yellow/white pus discharge                                 | Kidney Yin deficiency with fire, or Liver/Gallbladder damp-heat |
| Ear color: white                                           | Sudden wind-cold invasion                                       |
| Ear color: green/black                                     | Pain                                                            |
| Ear color: black                                           | Kidney failure                                                  |
| Ear color: red                                             | Excess heat (possibly damp-heat)                                |
| Ear color: yellow                                          | Damp accumulation                                               |

| Tinnitus Pitch                   | Organ  |
|----------------------------------|--------|
| High-pitched (like cicadas)      | Liver  |
| Low-pitched (like rushing water) | Kidney |

Quick Recall: High-pitch tinnitus = Liver (cicada). Low-pitch = Kidney (water).

8 • Five Sense Organs IV: Teeth, Gums, Lips/Mouth, Throat

Teeth (Kidney — teeth are the "surplus of bone")

| Finding                             | Pattern                    |
|-------------------------------------|----------------------------|
| White, moist sheen, bright/clean    | Strong Kidney Qi           |
| Dry, no sheen                       | Kidney Yin decline         |
| Yellowing (gradual, with age)       | Normal aging               |
| Sudden dull yellow (like a soybean) | Kidney deficiency          |
| Gray and black (like a black bean)  | Exhaustion of Yin and Yang |

|                                            |                                                                                                                                 |
|--------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Dry, black, gray                           | Kidney Yin deficiency                                                                                                           |
| Tartar, grimy yellow                       | Stomach turbidity                                                                                                               |
| Burnt and dry                              | Kidney & Stomach Yin deficiency                                                                                                 |
| Delayed baby/adult teeth                   | Essence and Jing deficiency                                                                                                     |
| Teeth growing at deviated angles / missing | Insufficient Yangming Qi (Stomach/LI wrap the mouth & gums, which are Flesh/Earth — not enough Earth Qi to hold teeth in place) |
| Loss of teeth in adult, receding gums      | Fire flaring upward from Kidney Yin deficiency                                                                                  |

### Gums (Spleen/Stomach — Flesh)

| Finding                          | Pattern                                   |
|----------------------------------|-------------------------------------------|
| Moist, deep red (normal)         | Normal                                    |
| Deep red + swelling              | Excess heat / Stomach fire                |
| Pale                             | Blood deficiency                          |
| Atrophied                        | Kidney deficiency                         |
| Blue line between teeth and gums | Mercury poisoning                         |
| Swollen, ulcerated, bleeding     | Stomach fire pushing blood out of vessels |

### Lips & Mouth (Spleen opens to the mouth)

| Finding                                                         | Pattern                                                           |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Pale lips                                                       | Blood deficiency                                                  |
| Blue-purplish lips                                              | Retention of cold OR blood stagnation                             |
| Bright red lips                                                 | Heat toxins                                                       |
| Crimson lips                                                    | Yin-deficiency heat                                               |
| Dry, red lips                                                   | Heat damaging fluids                                              |
| Purple lips                                                     | Blood stasis (stabbing pain)                                      |
| Deviated mouth                                                  | Wind (deviation of face/mouth = wind; deviated tongue = wind too) |
| Mouth slightly open                                             | Deficiency pattern                                                |
| Mouth remains open + high fever, red face, thirst, canker sores | Excess heat                                                       |
| Breathing through open mouth                                    | Empty/deficiency pattern                                          |
| Open mouth + SOB + cough + frothy sputum                        | Lung deficiency with phlegm stagnation                            |
| Sudden attack, open mouth, drooling, loss of consciousness      | Wind                                                              |

### Throat & Tonsils (Stomach + Lung primarily)

| Finding                                    | Pattern                                              |
|--------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|
| Deep red throat/pharynx                    | Heat                                                 |
| Pale red throat                            | Empty (deficiency) heat                              |
| Acute pain + redness + swelling            | Wind invasion (acute = exterior)                     |
| Chronic redness/swelling                   | Interior organ heat (Stomach heat)                   |
| Chronic sore, dry throat, NOT swollen/red  | Lung and/or Kidney Yin deficiency with empty heat    |
| Erosion, redness, swelling, yellowish-red  | Heat in Stomach/Intestines                           |
| Chronic erosion, comes and goes            | Empty (deficiency) heat                              |
| Chronic erosion w/ hard raised-edge ulcers | Blood stasis with phlegm-heat                        |
| Swollen tonsils, normal color              | Damp/phlegm retention on background of Qi deficiency |
| Chronically red/swollen tonsils            | Heat or toxic heat in Stomach/Large Intestine        |

|                                |                                       |
|--------------------------------|---------------------------------------|
| Acutely red/swollen tonsils    | Wind-heat invasion with heat toxicity |
| Acute red/swollen with exudate | Heat toxins in Stomach/LI (vs. cold)  |

9 • Hair, Nails & Skin

Hair (reflects Blood + Kidney Essence; "women ruled by Blood, men ruled by Qi")

| Finding                                | Pattern                                                  |
|----------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------|
| Original color, shiny, lustrous, moist | Sufficient Blood and Kidney essence                      |
| Premature graying                      | Depletion of Kidney essence                              |
| Dull, brittle, easily broken           | Deficiency of Kidney essence (or Liver Blood deficiency) |
| Thick, lustrous                        | Sufficient Blood and Kidney essence                      |
| Thin, sparse                           | Deficiency of Kidney                                     |
| Thinning / falling out (general)       | Blood deficiency                                         |
| Falling out in patches                 | Blood deficiency within the channels                     |

Nails (reflect the Liver)

| Finding                                               | Pattern                                                                  |
|-------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Pink, normal luster                                   | Sufficient Qi                                                            |
| Dark red                                              | Heat                                                                     |
| Pale                                                  | Blood deficiency or cold                                                 |
| Nail bed blanches white, returns to color immediately | Sufficient Qi and Blood                                                  |
| Nail bed returns to color slowly                      | Exhaustion of Qi and Blood                                               |
| Withered, dried                                       | Liver or Kidney Yin insufficiency; chronic Bi obstruction                |
| Atrophied / peeled                                    | Yin deficiency                                                           |
| Soft and thin                                         | Deficiency of Blood                                                      |
| Rough, thick, dull, no transparency                   | Qi and Blood deficiency with wind                                        |
| Longitudinal striping / blood loss appearance         | Liver Blood deficiency, trauma, or fungal infection                      |
| Brittle                                               | Blood deficiency, wind, or trauma                                        |
| Hook-shaped                                           | Qi and Blood stagnation, or wind-painful obstruction                     |
| Spoon-shaped                                          | Qi and Blood stagnation, malnutrition, Spleen deficiency, chronic Bi     |
| Ridged                                                | Kidney Yin deficiency, Liver Yang rising, or Blood deficiency            |
| Bluish veins on thenar eminence (palm)                | Cold in the Stomach (thenar eminence reflects Stomach, via Lung channel) |
| Short bluish veins, thenar                            | Empty (deficiency) pattern                                               |
| Red veins, thenar                                     | Heat                                                                     |
| Purple veins, thenar                                  | Blood stasis                                                             |

Skin

| Finding                             | Pattern                        |
|-------------------------------------|--------------------------------|
| Lustrous, harmonious color (normal) | Normal                         |
| Red                                 | Heat                           |
| Yellow, orangish                    | Damp-heat, more heat than damp |
| Yellow, dusky                       | Damp-heat, more damp than heat |
| Too moist                           | Lung not controlling fluids    |



|                                                  |                                                                 |
|--------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|
| Dry                                              | Blood deficiency / fluid deficiency                             |
| Dark, with scales                                | Blood stasis                                                    |
| Itching                                          | Wind                                                            |
| Pitting edema (upper body downward)              | Yang edema – Spleen/Kidney Yang deficiency, fluid not mobilized |
| Non-pitting edema                                | Qi stagnation or dampness                                       |
| Edema starting from feet/lower body, worse below | Yin edema                                                       |

### Skin Lesions

| Lesion  | Description                                                                        |
|---------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Papule  | Seed-sized rash, red, distinct raised borders, palpable; color fades with pressure |
| Macule  | Flat red patch, clear edges, no swelling; color does NOT fade with pressure        |
| Blister | Fluid-filled (clear or turbid), thick or thin walls                                |
| Nodule  | Palpable, solid, round lesion                                                      |

| Term                            | Cause                                                                 |
|---------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Yong (癰) – carbuncle, Yang-type | Internal accumulation of fire toxins                                  |
| Ju (瘰) – carbuncle, Yin-type    | Insufficient Qi/Blood + internal stagnation of Qi, Yin, and cold      |
| Ding (癰) – boil/furuncle        | Exogenous wind-fire toxins, or accumulated heat toxins on the surface |
| Jie (癰) – furuncle              | Stagnated Qi and Blood due to damp-heat in the skin                   |

## 10 • Secretions & Excretions — General Logic

| Quality                                         | Reading                               |
|-------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------|
| Color: white                                    | Cold                                  |
| Color: yellow                                   | Heat                                  |
| Consistency: thin, clear, watery                | Deficiency / cold                     |
| Consistency: thick, sticky                      | Excess / heat                         |
| Quantity: profuse                               | Cold                                  |
| Quantity: scanty                                | Deficiency / heat (heat dries fluids) |
| Odor: none/faint                                | Cold                                  |
| Odor: strong                                    | Heat                                  |
| Form: with distinct form (e.g., hard dry stool) | Excess, tends toward heat             |
| Form: formless / watery                         | Deficiency, tends toward cold         |

*Quick Recall: White/thin/profuse/no-odor = cold-deficiency cluster. Yellow/thick/scanty/strong-odor = heat-excess cluster.*

**Heads Up —**
 These four axes (color, consistency, quantity, odor) apply across nasal discharge, sputum, stool, and vaginal discharge alike — one framework, many tissues. Expect the quiz to test this transferable logic, not just one secretion type.

## 11 • Pediatric Diagnosis — Infant Finger Venous Diagnosis

Used for children under 3 years old (before the radial pulse is reliably palpable). Practitioner holds the child's hand with the left hand and rubs the index finger's radial-side vein toward the body (proximally) with the right thumb.

| Side Examined      | Sex   |
|--------------------|-------|
| Left index finger  | Boys  |
| Right index finger | Girls |

| Gate the vein reaches         | Severity                             |
|-------------------------------|--------------------------------------|
| Wind Gate only (1st segment)  | Mild illness / exterior pathogen     |
| Qi Gate (2nd segment)         | Interior condition, stronger illness |
| Life Gate (3rd segment)       | Severe illness                       |
| Beyond Life Gate to fingertip | Life-threatening                     |

Quick Recall: Wind → Qi → Life Gate = mild → stronger → severe → past the tip = life-threatening. Mnemonic: Wei-Qi-Ying-Xue four-level logic (Qi = interior stage).

| Vein Color (after rubbing)  | Indication                     |
|-----------------------------|--------------------------------|
| Light red, not very visible | Normal                         |
| Bright red                  | Heat                           |
| Purple                      | Stronger heat, creating stasis |
| Green or dark blue          | Wind                           |

**Heads Up** — This technique is infant-only (age <3) — it will not show reliably on adults. Don't confuse with the general adult nail-bed blanch test.

## 12 · Shen Vocabulary, the Su Wen 32 Face Map & Facial Variables

Prof. Schrier's slides add Chinese-term precision to Shen assessment and a second, distinct facial map from the one in Section 5's eye wheels — this one assigns heat disease to face regions.

### Having Shen vs. Loss of Shen vs. False Shen

| Observation     | Having Shen (yǒu shén)         | Loss of Shen (shī shén)     | False Shen (jiǎ shén)        |
|-----------------|--------------------------------|-----------------------------|------------------------------|
| Complexion      | Bright and moist               | Dim, dull sheen             | Dull, then suddenly lustrous |
| Eyes            | Alert, vivid, twinkle          | Dull, blurred vision        | Dull, then suddenly bright   |
| Mind/Speech     | Clear speech, conscious, agile | Unconscious, delirious      | Unclear, then sudden change  |
| Motion/Response | Quick, appropriate             | Sluggish and slow           | Suddenly responsive          |
| Respiration     | Even                           | Rapid, feeble, or difficult | Feeble, then briefly steady  |

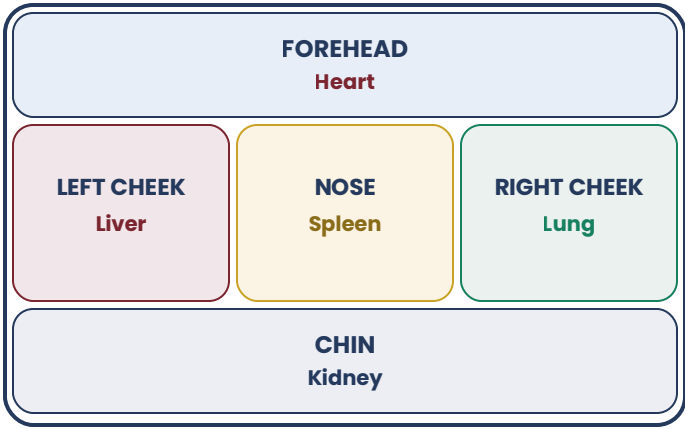
**Heads Up** — False Shen (also called a "flare before the flame goes out") is a critical-condition finding: a listless, unconscious patient with dull eyes suddenly appears clearer, brighter-eyed, and hungrier. This is a warning sign, not genuine recovery.

### Manifestations of Deranged Shen (shén luàn)

| Term                                  | Presentation                                                                                                |
|---------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Irritability & Restlessness (fán zào) | Hot/feverish sensation with irritability; can drive the patient to seek cold/water                          |
| Visceral Agitation (zàng zào)         | Mental depression, hallucination, disorientation, crying spells, frequent yawning, no loss of consciousness |
| Lily Disease (bái hé bìng)            | Chronic depression, apathy, aversion to speaking, mumbling to self, insomnia, anorexia, sleepwalking        |
| Yin Madness (diān)                    | Chronic depression, aversion to speaking or mumbling, laughing/crying inappropriately                       |
| Yang Madness (kuáng)                  | Raving, obscenities, restlessness, singing loudly in public, wandering naked, aggression                    |

### Su Wen 32 — Heat Disease Face Map

Distinct from the Section 5 Five Wheels (which map eye sub-structures). This map assigns organ heat disease to broad face regions — classic homework/quiz material per both decks.



| Face Region | Organ Heat Disease |
|-------------|--------------------|
| Left cheek  | Liver              |
| Forehead    | Heart              |
| Nose        | Spleen             |
| Right cheek | Lung               |
| Chin        | Kidney             |

Quick Recall: Su Wen 32: L cheek=Liver, Forehead=Heart, Nose=Spleen, R cheek=Lung, Chin=Kidney.

Facial Diagnosis Variables

| Variable                          | Definition                                                                   |
|-----------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Original/Host Color (bǎn miàn sè) | The person's baseline facial color, fixed and unchanged throughout life      |
| Guest/Visitor Color               | Slight, temporary facial color shifts following seasonal and climatic change |
| Normal Variables                  | Temporary color changes due to environment, light, emotion, activity, etc.   |

| Attribute    | Reflects                                        | Associated With |
|--------------|-------------------------------------------------|-----------------|
| Facial Color | Color of the skin                               | Blood and Yin   |
| Facial Sheen | Luster/moisture of the skin ("contained" color) | Qi and Yang     |

Quick Recall: Normal complexion = a subtle, slightly reddish hue with a gentle sheen — color from Blood/Yin, sheen from Qi/Yang.

13 • Excreta & Secretions — Quiz-Yourself Framework

Prof. Schrier’s deck presents this exact framework as a self-test slide (fill-in-the-blank) — treat this table as near-verbatim quiz material.

| Axis     | Value       | Reading                          |
|----------|-------------|----------------------------------|
| Color    | White       | Cold                             |
| Color    | Yellow      | Heat                             |
| Quantity | Scanty      | Deficiency / heat (dries fluids) |
| Quantity | Profuse     | Cold                             |
| Quality  | Formed      | Excess                           |
| Quality  | Formless    | Deficiency                       |
| Quality  | Thick       | Excess / heat                    |
| Quality  | Thin        | Deficiency / cold                |
| Odor     | No odor     | Cold                             |
| Odor     | Strong odor | Heat                             |

**Heads Up** — This is the same logic as Section 10, restructured exactly the way Prof. Schrier's slide poses it (fill-in-the-blank). If the quiz uses a fill-in format, expect it to look like this table.

14 · Constitutional Types (Flagged — See Scope Conflict on Cover)

**Heads Up** — Included because Prof. Schrier's own deck devotes ~9 of 41 slides to this topic, despite Prof. Lao's recorded statement that constitutions would not be tested. Confirm scope with Prof. Schrier before deciding how hard to study this section.

Weak vs. Strong Constitution (Ling Shu 54)

| Constitutional Marker  | Weak Constitution                 | Strong Constitution                 |
|------------------------|-----------------------------------|-------------------------------------|
| Eyes/nose/ears/mouth   | Close together                    | Well-proportioned                   |
| Space between eyebrows | Small                             | Broad forehead and glabella         |
| Nose                   | Narrow, nostrils turned up/flared | Straight and made from a nice mold  |
| Philtrum               | Short                             | Long                                |
| Cheeks                 | Thin                              | Full, with normal complexion/luster |
| Jaw                    | Flat, sunken, low, narrow         | Strong lower jaw, even and smooth   |
| Ears                   | Small, short earlobes             | Long ears with long earlobes        |
| Muscles/skin           | Flabby, loose                     | Firm                                |

Quick Recall: Small, close-together features = weak constitution. Broad, long, well-proportioned features = strong constitution.

| Cause of Weak Constitution                                                                      |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Parents' general health                                                                         |
| Health at time of conception                                                                    |
| Mother's health during pregnancy                                                                |
| Parental age and pregnancy events (emotional stress, trauma, drugs/medications/alcohol/smoking) |

**Heads Up** — Constitution is not fixed: Pre-Heavenly (Jing) essence is the basis, but Post-Heavenly Qi (diet, lifestyle, herbs, acupuncture, breathing/physical practice — yang sheng) can improve it over a lifetime.

Five-Element Body Types (Ling Shu 64, per Maciocia)

| Element | Physical Appearance                                                                                                                      | Personality                                                                                                                         |
|---------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Wood    | Greenish complexion, small head, long face, broad shoulders, straight back, sinewy body, tall                                            | Superior talent, uses more mind than body, compensates for grief through hard work, survives sickness                               |
| Fire    | Red complexion, small head, well-developed shoulders/back/buttocks/abdomen, small hands/feet, curly or little hair, walks fast and sways | Frivolous with wealth, little accountability, good-looking and passionate, quick decisions, tendency to violent death, very curious |
| Earth   | Yellowish complexion, round face, big head, wide jaws, large abdomen, strong thighs/calves, walks without lifting feet                   | Dignified, content, calm in peace and quiet, unassertive, likes helping people, dislikes power/violence, very modest                |
| Metal   | Pale complexion, square face, small head/shoulders, flat abdomen, strong voice, walks slowly and deliberately                            | Keen thinker, honest, upright, quiet, calm, rational, aptitude for leadership                                                       |
| Water   | Dark complexion, big head, wrinkles, round face and body, broad cheeks, large abdomen, long spine, swaying gait                          | Laid back, unafraid, tendency to deceive/betray others, prone to violent death, active always moving                                |

Quick Recall: Wood=tall/sinewy/hardworking. Fire=curly hair/passionate/impulsive. Earth=round/big-head/calm-helper. Metal=square-face/honest/leader. Water=dark/wrinkled/deceptive.

Quiz Scope Reminder

**Heads Up —** Two sources, two different answers on Constitution: Prof. Lao's recorded lecture says **"Nothing on the body constitutions"** will be tested; Prof. Schrier's own slide deck devotes substantial space to it (Section 14). Verify directly with Prof. Schrier which governs this quiz before finalizing your study time allocation.